

Q. Let's first dive into the Quad Sherpa meeting in New Delhi on September 3, with representatives of the US, India, Japan and Australia. What can you tell us about this meeting and the possible outcomes?

The Quad is very important to all of us and this meeting was essential to the one that will happen next month in Sydney, Australia, where Secretary of State Marco Rubio will travel to meet his counterparts. What does the Quad represent? It is a group of partners that trust each other. The Quad is working across various areas together, and that includes humanitarian and disaster relief, joint training and interoperability between all four partners. Part of the Quad relates to new and emerging technology. We discussed everything from AI to data centres to, of course, critical minerals. There is so much that the Quad can work together on, and that's something that we have reinvigorated.

Q. Would the Quad Leaders' Summit later be on the sidelines of the G20 in Florida?

I don't want to make any commitments just yet, but I will tell you this: the United States is incredibly interested in a Leaders' Summit. The four leaders speak with each other regularly, so the next natural step is for all of them to be together around one table to advance these shared common goals and priorities.

Q. You maintain a busy travel schedule across India, including having meetings with Union commerce minister Piyush Goyal, the NSA (National Security Advisor) and also the state chief ministers. What can you tell us about these conversations?

It's vitally important for me and our embassy team to get out of New Delhi. When I travel to Mumbai, Bangalore or Hyderabad, I can see the incredible commercial, space and military opportunities. Pick any sector, and the US and India are working together on it. The relationship is stronger today than it was five years ago—whether that's pharma, IT and technology, or military exercises. India conducts more military exercises with the United States than anyone else. When it comes to trade, our bilateral trade today is $240 billion (Rs 22.6 lakh crore), and the two leaders identified a target of $500 billion (Rs 47.2 lakh crore) to achieve in the next few years. So no matter the sector, the US and India are growing it. Minister Goyal is an incredible individual. He travels just as much as I do, but when he is in town, we enjoy getting together.

Q. India recently posted 7.8 per cent GDP growth. What are you telling American businesses, including CEOs, about working with India?

Trade goes both ways, and every US embassy brings in new investments to the United States. We were incredibly pleased

"What gives me confidence is that the numbers don't lie. Year after year, our bilateral trade increases, so do our joint military exercises. The trajectory of this relationship is on a constant rise"

that my embassy here in India came in first with $24 billion. On the flip side, you're seeing American companies coming to India and opening up shop here—whether Microsoft, Google, data centres, AI centres, or pharma companies. It comes down to trust and stability. India doing well is a great thing for us. We want a stable India, and we want to work with a stable India. A lot of that credit goes to your prime minister. He brings a stability to India that doesn't exist in other parts of the world. It's an incredible achievement in such a vibrant democracy that your prime minister has been here for 12 years.

Q. Recently, there was an announcement of a joint venture with Tata Advanced Systems for the Javelin. Can we expect more such deals in the future?

Our defence relationship is not just about sales; it's also about trust. India is in a group of partners that the US trusts. We believe we have the best and most advanced technology, and working with trusted partners like India is an incredible opportunity. Whether that's the Javelins you mentioned, the